

Student Guide — Lesson 7: Facial Expression Recognition and Virtual Pets

Meet your virtual pet! Today it reacts to different moods. 🚀

Try it

1. Open `project.sb3`, click the green flag.
2. Press **H** for Happy, **S** for Sad, **W** for Surprised (Wow!).
3. Watch the pet's costume, sound, and its **Happiness** meter change!

Look at the code

Open the pet sprite's code. Find the block that checks for each key press, and the block that changes the Happiness variable.

Important truth

🤖 Robot Tip: Right now, keys stand in for REAL facial expressions. A real trained model (from Teachable Machine or ML4Kids) could one day look at your actual face through the webcam and send the same signal these keys do — follow `AI_Training_Guide.md` to try it!

New words

- **Mood/emotion class:** one category of facial expression the model could learn (happy, sad, surprised).
- **Meter/variable:** a number that goes up or down to track something, like Happiness.